Housing Affordability SQL Project

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1. Perspective and End Consumers

This project answers 45 questions about one perspective, **housing affordability: what homes cost, where, and how prices are changing**, for three different end consumers. Each consumer has 15 questions: 5 easy, 5 medium and 5 difficult. The SQL is in `PricePaid_Queries.sql`, and the data is loaded by `pricepaid_setup.sql`.

#	End consumer	Questions	What they need from the data
1	First-time buyer adviser at a housing advice charity	Q1–Q15	Entry-level prices, the cheapest areas and property types, flats vs houses, leasehold vs freehold, where prices are rising fastest
2	Local authority housing planner	Q16–Q30	Price levels and trends by district, new-build supply and its premium, gaps between areas, how much of the market is investor-driven
3	Property market journalist	Q31–Q45	Headline trends, hotspots and cooling areas, record sales, monthly momentum, outliers

Two conventions apply throughout:

- **“Homes”** means standard market-value sales (category A), excluding the “Other” property type, unless a question says otherwise.
- **Year-on-year comparisons are like-for-like**, January–September 2025 against January–September 2026, because the 2026 data ends on 30 September.

2. Dataset Profile

The data is HM Land Registry’s Price Paid Data: every residential property sale in England and Wales lodged with the Land Registry, from 1 January 2025 to 30 September 2026. It is published on gov.uk under the Open Government Licence.

Item	Detail
Rows	1,450,241 sales (992,278 in 2025; 457,963 in 2026 to 30 September)
Tables	`sales` (16 columns), plus lookups `property_types` (5 rows) and `tenures` (3 rows)
Grain	One row per sale
Engine	MySQL 8

2.1 Loading

Both yearly CSV files, which have no header row, were loaded into one `sales` table with `LOAD DATA LOCAL INFILE`. Each field was cleaned on the way in: dates were converted to DATE, blank text became NULL, and a stray Windows line-ending character was removed from the last column. Indexes were added on date, district, property type and county. The two lookup tables turn the one-letter codes into readable labels.

2.2 Columns

Column	Type	Meaning
transaction_id	VARCHAR	Unique sale reference (primary key)
price	INT	Sale price in £
date_of_transfer	DATE	Completion date
postcode	VARCHAR	Postcode of the property
property_type	CHAR	D detached, S semi-detached, T terraced, F flat/maisonette, O other
old_new	CHAR	Y new build, N existing home
duration	CHAR	F freehold, L leasehold, U unknown
paon, saon	VARCHAR	House number or name; flat number
street, locality, town_city	VARCHAR	Address parts
district	VARCHAR	Local authority district
county	VARCHAR	County or unitary authority

Column	Type	Meaning
ppd_category	CHAR	A standard market sale; B additional (repossessions, buy-to-let, company purchases)
record_status	CHAR	A added (all rows in the yearly files)

2.3 Data quality

Issue	Scale	How it was handled
2026 is a partial year	Data ends 30 September 2026	Year-on-year comparisons use January–September only
Additional-price-paid sales	235,117 sales (16%) are category B	Excluded from affordability questions unless the question is about them
“Other” property type	66,285 sales, mostly category B, often non-residential	Excluded from “homes”
New-build registration lag	New-builds are registered months after completion, so 2026 has few	New-build questions use 2025–2026 combined
Very low category A prices	Some sales from £800 to £30,000, likely part-shares or non-standard transfers	Kept, and noted where they appear
Missing postcodes	A small number of sales	Kept; shown in Q19

3. End Consumer 1: First-Time Buyer Adviser

An adviser at a housing advice charity helps first-time buyers work out what they can afford and where. They need entry-level prices, the cheapest areas and property types, the realities of flats and leasehold, and where starter prices are rising fastest.

Easy

Q1

Question: What were the 20 cheapest flats sold at market value in Greater London in 2026?

Concept: Basic SELECT - WHERE, ORDER BY, LIMIT

date_of_transfer	price	saon	paon	street	postcode	district
2026-08-20	76500	FLAT 14	NAYLAND COURT	MARKET PLACE	RM1 3EF	HAVERING
2026-07-22	79500	FLAT 61	GREEN BANK LODGE	FOREST CLOSE	BR7 5QS	BROMLEY
2026-07-10	81000	FLAT 8	PENCEAT COURT, 17	BOURDON ROAD	SE20 7SH	BROMLEY
2026-01-22	82000	FLAT 23	HOLMOAKS HOUSE, 47	BROMLEY ROAD	BR3 5PA	BROMLEY
2026-03-17	82000	NULL	25	BARNETTS COURT	HA2 8EU	HARROW
2026-03-27	82250	NULL	40	BEADLE PLACE	DA8 3FE	BEXLEY
2026-03-05	83000	26	MACMILLAN COURT	RAYNERS LANE	HA2 9TJ	HARROW
2026-03-27	83000	NULL	23	VERONA CLOSE	UB8 2LJ	HILLINGDON
2026-05-29	83000	NULL	40	WOODVILLE GROVE	DA16 3QA	BEXLEY
2026-03-05	83750	22	DUKE COURT	STATION ROAD	HA2 6DD	HARROW
2026-04-30	84000	FLAT 14	CATALINA COURT, 61 - 63	SUNNY BANK	SE25 4TZ	CROYDON
2026-07-21	85000	17	MONTAGUE LODGE, 95	RECTORY ROAD	BR3 1XF	BROMLEY
2026-09-02	85000	FLAT 16	LONGDON COURT, 35	JUNCTION ROAD	RM1 3QY	HAVERING
2026-06-12	85000	FLAT 5	FERNLEIGH COURT, 95	MAWNEY ROAD	RM7 7JE	HAVERING
2026-01-20	85000	NULL	146A	UPPER WICKHAM LANE	DA16 3DX	BEXLEY
2026-03-02	85000	NULL	33	VERONA CLOSE	UB8 2LJ	HILLINGDON
2026-04-01	85000	FLAT 4	AZALEA COURT, 75	WHYTECLIFFE ROAD SOUTH	CR8 2AX	CROYDON
2026-09-22	85000	15	MACMILLAN COURT	RAYNERS LANE	HA2 9TJ	HARROW
2026-05-13	85000	FLAT 3	AZALEA COURT, 75	WHYTECLIFFE ROAD SOUTH	CR8 2AX	CROYDON
2026-01-27	85500	FLAT 7	GRIFFIN HOUSE, 399	LONDON ROAD	CR0 3FH	CROYDON

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The cheapest flats sold in Greater London in 2026 went for £76,500–£85,500, all in outer boroughs such as Havering, Bromley, Harrow, Bexley, Hillingdon and Croydon. Many are in named courts and lodges, which can indicate retirement or other restricted housing, so an adviser should check eligibility before pointing first-time buyers to them.

Q2

Question: Which terraced houses sold at market value for under £150,000 in September 2026? Show the most recent 25.

Concept: Basic WHERE - comparison, BETWEEN

date_of_transfer	price	street	town_city	district	county
2026-09-30	100000	STANLEY ROAD	PORTSMOUTH	PORTSMOUTH	PORTSMOUTH
2026-09-29	90000	CESTRIAN STREET	DEESIDE	FLINTSHIRE	FLINTSHIRE
2026-09-29	117527	HOLKER STREET	BARROW-IN-FURNESS	WESTMORLAND AND FURNESS	WESTMORLAND AND FURNESS
2026-09-29	122000	SYLVAN DRIVE	NEWPORT	ISLE OF WIGHT	ISLE OF WIGHT
2026-09-28	60000	FERN STREET	OLDHAM	OLDHAM	GREATER MANCHESTER
2026-09-28	122500	CELANDINE CLOSE	LOWESTOFT	EAST SUFFOLK	SUFFOLK
2026-09-28	130000	SOVEREIGNS WAY	DEWSBURY	KIRKLEES	WEST YORKSHIRE
2026-09-28	135000	BONTUCHAF	BANGOR	GWYNEDD	GWYNEDD
2026-09-28	136000	BRECON ROAD	MERTHYR TYDFIL	MERTHYR TYDFIL	MERTHYR TYDFIL
2026-09-28	142000	JURY LANE	HAVERFORDWEST	PEMBROKESHIRE	PEMBROKESHIRE
2026-09-28	143000	RAWSTHORNE STREET	BOLTON	BOLTON	GREATER MANCHESTER
2026-09-25	24202	LAVERICK TERRACE	STANLEY	COUNTY DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM
2026-09-25	45208	HONEYSUCKLE DRIVE	NANTWICH	CHESHIRE EAST	CHESHIRE EAST
2026-09-25	46000	MAUREEN TERRACE	SEAHAM	COUNTY DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM
2026-09-25	48200	HILL STREET	ROSSENDALE	ROSSENDALE	LANCASHIRE
2026-09-25	52900	DUNCAN STREET	BARROW-IN-FURNESS	WESTMORLAND AND FURNESS	WESTMORLAND AND FURNESS

date_of_transfer	price	street	town_city	district	county
2026-09-25	58000	PARMETER STREET	STANLEY	COUNTY DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM
2026-09-25	63000	BOLTON ROAD	BRADFORD	BRADFORD	WEST YORKSHIRE
2026-09-25	65000	RODNEY STREET	ST HELENS	ST HELENS	MERSEYSIDE
2026-09-25	69000	BEMROSE WAY	GRIMSBY	NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE	NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE
2026-09-25	70000	LOVAINE STREET	CHESTER LE STREET	COUNTY DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM
2026-09-25	75000	HEBER STREET	GOOLE	EAST RIDING OF YORKSHIRE	EAST RIDING OF YORKSHIRE
2026-09-25	80000	HAIG AVENUE	WHITEHAVEN	CUMBERLAND	CUMBERLAND
2026-09-25	82000	PHILLIPS LANE	GRIMSBY	NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE	NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE
2026-09-25	82500	STANLEY CLOSE	STOCKTON-ON-TEES	STOCKTON-ON-TEES	STOCKTON-ON-TEES

25 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: In the last days of September 2026, terraced houses under £150,000 sold mainly in the North of England and Wales, including County Durham, Greater Manchester, Cumbria and Lincolnshire, several for under £60,000. These are the areas where genuinely low-cost starter houses still exist.

Q3

Question: Which houses (not flats) were sold as leasehold in 2026 for under £250,000? Show the 25 cheapest.

Concept: Basic WHERE - IN, AND

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	street	town_city	district
2026-04-20	20000	T	FURNESS STREET	BURNLEY	BURNLEY
2026-06-23	25000	T	BAR STREET	BURNLEY	BURNLEY
2026-04-24	25000	T	KIME STREET	BURNLEY	BURNLEY
2026-01-30	27500	T	NEWPORT ROAD	GREAT YARMOUTH	GREAT YARMOUTH
2026-06-26	27728	T	GARDEN STREET	ACCRINGTON	HYNDBURN
2026-01-29	28125	T	BRAEMAR DRIVE	BIRMINGHAM	BIRMINGHAM

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	street	town_city	district
2026-02-18	29281	T	ELIZABETH STREET	BURNLEY	BURNLEY
2026-06-12	29400	T	NEWHAVEN COURT	HARTLEPOOL	HARTLEPOOL
2026-06-26	30000	T	NAPIER STREET	STOCKTON-ON-TEES	STOCKTON-ON-TEES
2026-06-18	30000	D	EASTGATE COURT	ACCRINGTON	HYNDBURN
2026-09-11	30000	T	NAPIER STREET	STOCKTON-ON-TEES	STOCKTON-ON-TEES
2026-02-20	30000	T	CROSSBECK WAY	MIDDLESBROUGH	REDCAR AND CLEVELAND
2026-06-24	30000	D	WOLFBERRY DRIVE	LIVERPOOL	LIVERPOOL
2026-03-12	32000	T	LEYMOOR ROAD	HUDDERSFIELD	KIRKLEES
2026-04-10	32000	T	KINROSS DRIVE	STANLEY	COUNTY DURHAM
2026-07-17	34000	S	BELLADONNA ROAD	LIVERPOOL	LIVERPOOL
2026-03-03	34000	D	COLSTONE CLOSE	WILMSLOW	CHESHIRE EAST
2026-08-13	34000	T	CLAREMONT ROAD	SOUTHPORT	SEFTON
2026-07-27	35000	T	DANE STREET SOUTH	ROTHERHAM	BARNSLEY
2026-06-17	35000	T	BLAKELOCK GARDENS	HARTLEPOOL	HARTLEPOOL
2026-04-10	35000	T	BURNWAY	WASHINGTON	SUNDERLAND
2026-02-25	36000	T	LARK STREET	BURNLEY	BURNLEY
2026-03-06	37500	T	KENDRA WAY	BRADFORD	BRADFORD
2026-03-18	37800	T	EVELYN STREET	BURNLEY	BURNLEY
2026-04-24	38000	T	GREEN STREET	BURNLEY	BURNLEY

25 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The cheapest leasehold houses sold for as little as £20,000, concentrated in Burnley and other Lancashire and North East towns. Leasehold houses at these prices may carry ground-rent, lease-length or condition issues, so buyers need legal advice before committing.

Q4

Question: Which new-build flats in Manchester sold at market value for between £150,000 and £250,000 across 2025-2026? Show the 25 most recent.

Concept: Basic WHERE - BETWEEN, AND

date_of_transfer	price	saon	paon	street	postcode
2025-11-27	234710	FLAT 202	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-10-17	245000	FLAT 603	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-10-16	239010	FLAT 107	7	DUTTON STREET	M3 1AS
2025-10-10	165252	FLAT 509	VICTORIA MILL, 8	LOWER VICKERS STREET	M40 7NA
2025-10-03	249000	FLAT 110	WATERHOUSE TOWER, 1	DUTTON STREET	M3 1AB
2025-09-30	184995	FLAT 201	VICTORIA MILL, 8	LOWER VICKERS STREET	M40 7NA
2025-09-22	235000	FLAT 6	2	HULME HALL ROAD	M15 4LY
2025-08-21	228000	FLAT 1006	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LG
2025-08-18	232750	FLAT 506	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-18	241500	FLAT 402	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-15	245000	FLAT 602	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-15	232750	FLAT 507	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-14	250000	FLAT 1307	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LG
2025-08-14	241500	FLAT 403	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-14	235690	FLAT 302	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-14	230790	FLAT 307	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-14	241080	FLAT 907	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LG
2025-08-13	247755	FLAT 802	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-12	234710	FLAT 203	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-11	250000	FLAT 1103	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LG
2025-08-08	237650	FLAT 502	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-08	237552	FLAT 606	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-05	245765	FLAT 703	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LF
2025-08-05	235250	FLAT 1407	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LG
2025-08-05	240750	FLAT 1707	190	DANTZIC STREET	M4 4LH

25 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: New-build flats in Manchester in the £150,000–£250,000 range cluster in a few city-centre developments, especially 190 Dantzic Street (M4), selling for £228,000–£250,000. All 25 of the most recent sales are from 2025, which reflects the registration lag for 2026 new-builds.

Q5

Question: Which homes in Slough-area postcodes (starting "SL") sold at market value for under £300,000 in 2026? Show the 25 cheapest.

Concept: Basic WHERE - LIKE, NOT

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	postcode	street	town_city
2026-02-20	97375	F	SL6 0NS	INSTITUTE ROAD	MAIDENHEAD
2026-05-05	100000	F	SL6 0NF	MAYPOLE ROAD	MAIDENHEAD
2026-06-29	105000	F	SL2 4FJ	FOREST CLOSE	SLOUGH
2026-03-27	115000	F	SL1 5SR	FOTHERINGAY GARDENS	SLOUGH
2026-05-15	115000	F	SL1 2YU	TOPAZ CLOSE	SLOUGH
2026-06-29	121500	F	SL4 6AF	HIGH STREET	WINDSOR
2026-01-28	125000	F	SL2 1DA	FARNHAM ROAD	SLOUGH
2026-05-28	125000	F	SL1 5SU	BRAMBER COURT	SLOUGH
2026-03-24	125000	F	SL6 1YZ	SWANBROOK COURT	MAIDENHEAD
2026-02-02	126000	F	SL4 3RE	IMPERIAL ROAD	WINDSOR
2026-02-26	130000	F	SL4 3TP	GREEN LANE	WINDSOR
2026-01-16	132000	F	SL6 4FQ	BHAMRA GARDENS	MAIDENHEAD
2026-04-29	132000	F	SL1 3SE	GATEWICK CLOSE	SLOUGH
2026-07-30	132000	F	SL3 0RA	VICARAGE WAY	SLOUGH
2026-08-28	135500	F	SL6 1HD	GRENFELL ROAD	MAIDENHEAD
2026-05-26	138500	F	SL6 4QP	AUDLEY DRIVE	MAIDENHEAD
2026-05-22	139000	F	SL6 1YZ	SWANBROOK COURT	MAIDENHEAD
2026-04-20	140000	F	SL4 3GZ	ALMA ROAD	WINDSOR
2026-03-13	140000	F	SL1 9BD	ADELAIDE CLOSE	SLOUGH
2026-03-03	146000	F	SL6 2PR	CRESCENT DALE	MAIDENHEAD
2026-05-06	147500	F	SL4 3GZ	ALMA ROAD	WINDSOR
2026-08-28	148000	F	SL1 5HS	BOWER WAY	SLOUGH
2026-07-24	150000	F	SL2 1TS	GREYSTOKE ROAD	SLOUGH
2026-04-02	150000	F	SL6 8AA	MARKET STREET	MAIDENHEAD

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	postcode	street	town_city
2026-07-10	150000	F	SL9 9FU	MARPLE LANE	GERRARDS CROSS

25 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Every one of the 25 cheapest market homes in SL postcodes is a flat, starting at £97,375 in Maidenhead, with Slough flats from about £105,000. In this area the realistic entry point for a first-time buyer is a flat, not a house.

Medium

Q6

Question: In 2026, how many homes of each property type sold at market value, and what was the average and lowest price?

Concept: Join (lookup table) with GROUP BY

type_name	sales	avg_price	min_price
Flat/Maisonette	62710	291521	10000
Terraced	113278	302506	10000
Semi-detached	119666	327748	800
Detached	96816	503783	1200

4 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Flats were the cheapest home type in 2026 at an average of £291,521, but terraced houses cost only about 4% more (£302,506), while detached homes averaged £503,783. Minimum prices of £800–£10,000 point to non-standard transfers recorded as market sales.

Q7

Question: For flats sold at market value in 2026, how do the number of sales and average price compare between leasehold and freehold?

Concept: Join (lookup table) with GROUP BY

tenure_name	sales	avg_price
Leasehold	61345	291310
Freehold	1365	300994

2 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Almost all flats are sold leasehold: 61,345 against 1,365 freehold, about 98%. A first-time buyer choosing a flat should expect leasehold and budget for service charges and ground rent.

Q8

Question: Which 20 districts had the lowest average price for entry-level homes (flats and terraced houses) in 2026, counting only districts with at least 200 such sales?

Concept: GROUP BY / aggregation with HAVING

district	county	entry_level_sales	avg_price
MIDDLESBROUGH	MIDDLESBROUGH	231	97769
HARTLEPOOL	HARTLEPOOL	254	101497
BURNLEY	LANCASHIRE	422	107506
NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE	NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE	455	107831
BLACKPOOL	BLACKPOOL	460	113365
COUNTY DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM	1661	113564
HYNDBURN	LANCASHIRE	351	118120
STOKE-ON-TRENT	STOKE-ON-TRENT	542	118618
REDCAR AND CLEVELAND	REDCAR AND CLEVELAND	279	121361
SUNDERLAND	TYNE AND WEAR	701	124183
NORTH LINCOLNSHIRE	NORTH LINCOLNSHIRE	224	124421
DONCASTER	SOUTH YORKSHIRE	506	127269
STOCKTON-ON-TEES	STOCKTON-ON-TEES	364	127651
CITY OF KINGSTON UPON HULL	CITY OF KINGSTON UPON HULL	943	127722

district	county	entry_level_sales	avg_price
BLAENAU GWENT	BLAENAU GWENT	238	127852
DARLINGTON	DARLINGTON	301	129591
PENDLE	LANCASHIRE	466	133290
NEATH PORT TALBOT	NEATH PORT TALBOT	308	134661
PRESTON	LANCASHIRE	349	134888
BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	487	134997

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The cheapest districts for flats and terraced houses are in the North East, Lancashire and Lincolnshire, led by Middlesbrough (£97,769), Hartlepool (£101,497) and Burnley (£107,506). These entry-level prices are about a third of the national entry-level average of £298,591 (Q13).

Q9

Question: In which 15 counties is it hardest to find a home for under £250,000, measured by the share of 2026 market sales below that price (counties with 1,000+ sales)?

Concept: GROUP BY / conditional aggregation with HAVING

county	sales	sales_under_250k	pct_under_250k
GREATER LONDON	39781	2236	5.6
WOKINGHAM	1298	110	8.5
SURREY	8835	800	9.1
BUCKINGHAMSHIRE	3660	400	10.9
HERTFORDSHIRE	7784	864	11.1
OXFORDSHIRE	4756	561	11.8
BRIGHTON AND HOVE	1932	243	12.6
BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	1388	180	13.0
SOUTH GLOUCESTERSHIRE	2319	372	16.0
CENTRAL BEDFORDSHIRE	2338	386	16.5

county	sales	sales_under_250k	pct_under_250k
CITY OF BRISTOL	3390	579	17.1
WEST BERKSHIRE	1175	202	17.2
BEDFORD	1134	196	17.3
WEST SUSSEX	6756	1176	17.4
ESSEX	11297	2016	17.8

15 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Only 5.6% of 2026 home sales in Greater London were under £250,000, and fewer than 1 in 5 across much of the South East commuter belt, including Wokingham (8.5%) and Surrey (9.1%). First-time buyers there need larger deposits or schemes such as shared ownership.

Q10

Question: For each property type, how much more does a new-build cost on average than an existing home (2025-2026 market sales)?

Concept: Join + conditional aggregation

type_name	avg_new_build	avg_existing	new_build_premium_pct
Flat/Maisonette	506652	290674	74.3
Terraced	345917	302484	14.4
Semi-detached	364154	327704	11.1
Detached	482566	503853	-4.2

4 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: New-build flats cost 74% more than existing flats (£506,652 against £290,674), largely because new flats are concentrated in expensive city centres such as London. For houses the premium is 11–14%, and new detached homes are actually 4% cheaper than existing ones, probably because new estates have smaller detached homes than older stock.

Difficult

Q11

Question: Create a reusable view of market-value home sales with readable labels. Using it, what is the median 2026 price of each property type, compared with the average?

Concept: VIEW (creates v_homes) + CTE + window function (ROW_NUMBER / COUNT OVER for the median)

type_name	sales	median_price
Flat/Maisonette	62710	222200
Terraced	113278	240000
Semi-detached	119666	275000
Detached	96816	420000

4 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: For every property type the median price is well below the average: flats £222,200 against £291,521, and detached homes £420,000 against £503,783. A small number of high-value sales pull the averages up, so the median is the better guide to what a typical buyer pays.

Q12

Question: In each county, which district has the lowest average price for flats and terraced houses in 2026 (districts with at least 100 such sales)?

Concept: CTE + window function - RANK within a partition

county	cheapest_district	sales	avg_price
MIDDLESBROUGH	MIDDLESBROUGH	231	97769
HARTLEPOOL	HARTLEPOOL	254	101497
LANCASHIRE	BURNLEY	422	107506
NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE	NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE	455	107831
BLACKPOOL	BLACKPOOL	460	113365
COUNTY DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM	1661	113564
STOKE-ON-TRENT	STOKE-ON-TRENT	542	118618

county	cheapest_district	sales	avg_price
REDCAR AND CLEVELAND	REDCAR AND CLEVELAND	279	121361
TYNE AND WEAR	SUNDERLAND	701	124183
NORTH LINCOLNSHIRE	NORTH LINCOLNSHIRE	224	124421
NOTTINGHAMSHIRE	MANSFIELD	171	125593
SOUTH YORKSHIRE	DONCASTER	506	127269
STOCKTON-ON-TEES	STOCKTON-ON-TEES	364	127651
CITY OF KINGSTON UPON HULL	CITY OF KINGSTON UPON HULL	943	127722
BLAENAU GWENT	BLAENAU GWENT	238	127852
DARLINGTON	DARLINGTON	301	129591
MERTHYR TYDFIL	MERTHYR TYDFIL	156	131887
NEATH PORT TALBOT	NEATH PORT TALBOT	308	134661
BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	487	134997
DERBYSHIRE	BOLSOVER	175	136037

Showing 20 of 111 rows.

Interpretation: 111 counties have a district with enough entry-level sales; in many unitary authorities the county and district are the same area. The cheapest district per county ranges from Middlesbrough (£97,769) to Brighton and Hove (£414,940). Even the cheapest London borough, Bexley, averages £355,531, more than the cheapest district in almost every other county.

Q13

Question: Which districts have an average entry-level price (flats and terraced) below the national entry-level average in 2026, while still having a large market (500+ sales)?

Concept: Uses v_homes + subquery against a national benchmark

district	county	entry_level_sales	avg_price	national_avg
BIRMINGHAM	WEST MIDLANDS	2480	211967	298591
LEEDS	WEST YORKSHIRE	2292	205281	298591
NORTH YORKSHIRE	NORTH YORKSHIRE	1977	220061	298591
SOMERSET	SOMERSET	1819	223886	298591

district	county	entry_level_sales	avg_price	national_avg
CORNWALL	CORNWALL	1763	242726	298591
MANCHESTER	GREATER MANCHESTER	1688	254344	298591
COUNTY DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM	1661	113564	298591
BRADFORD	WEST YORKSHIRE	1640	166800	298591
WILTSHIRE	WILTSHIRE	1512	251264	298591
LIVERPOOL	MERSEYSIDE	1511	179396	298591
SHEFFIELD	SOUTH YORKSHIRE	1449	195643	298591
CARDIFF	CARDIFF	1435	246386	298591
BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	1406	265964	298591
DORSET	DORSET	1362	248621	298591
CITY OF PLYMOUTH	CITY OF PLYMOUTH	1304	205557	298591
KIRKLEES	WEST YORKSHIRE	1297	169836	298591
CHESHIRE EAST	CHESHIRE EAST	1150	235947	298591
PORTSMOUTH	PORTSMOUTH	1126	253656	298591
WEST NORTHAMPTONSHIRE	WEST NORTHAMPTONSHIRE	1090	226282	298591
COVENTRY	WEST MIDLANDS	1069	204996	298591

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Twenty large markets have entry-level prices below the national entry-level average of £298,591, led by Birmingham (2,480 sales, £211,967) and Leeds (2,292 sales, £205,281). These big cities combine plenty of homes for sale with relative affordability, making them strong options for first-time buyers.

Q14

Question: Where are entry-level prices rising fastest? Compare the average flat and terraced price in Jan-Sep 2025 with Jan-Sep 2026 by district (100+ sales in each period).

Concept: CTE + conditional aggregation + window function (RANK)

growth_rank	district	county	avg_2025	avg_2026	change_pct
1	WAVERLEY	SURREY	398620	473011	18.7

growth_rank	district	county	avg_2025	avg_2026	change_pct
2	NEWARK AND SHERWOOD	NOTTINGHAMSHIRE	165530	176951	6.9
3	RHONDDA CYNON TAFF	RHONDDA CYNON TAFF	136784	146011	6.7
4	CAERPHILLY	CAERPHILLY	159657	170171	6.6
5	SOUTH STAFFORDSHIRE	STAFFORDSHIRE	213039	226605	6.4
6	HYNDBURN	LANCASHIRE	111051	118120	6.4
7	BOLSOVER	DERBYSHIRE	128095	136037	6.2
8	YORK	YORK	289464	306346	5.8
9	MONMOUTHSHIRE	MONMOUTHSHIRE	241575	253471	4.9
10	MALVERN HILLS	WORCESTERSHIRE	237403	248868	4.8
11	PENDLE	LANCASHIRE	127399	133290	4.6
12	WELWYN HATFIELD	HERTFORDSHIRE	352833	368554	4.5
13	WREXHAM	WREXHAM	150963	157654	4.4
14	MERTHYR TYDFIL	MERTHYR TYDFIL	126293	131887	4.4
15	KING'S LYNN AND WEST NORFOLK	NORFOLK	203384	211826	4.2

15 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Waverley in Surrey stands out with an 18.7% rise, which is likely driven by a change in the mix of homes sold rather than a true price jump. The rest of the top 15 rose 4–7%, mainly lower-priced areas in Wales, Lancashire and the Midlands, so entry-level prices are rising fastest where they are lowest.

Q15

Question: What is the lower-quartile price (the typical "starter home" price) in each county in 2026, and how does it compare with the county median?

Concept: CTE + window function (PERCENT_RANK)

county	sales	lower_quartile_price	median_price
GREATER LONDON	39781	387750	515115
SURREY	8835	371000	501000
WOKINGHAM	1298	365000	476000
HERTFORDSHIRE	7784	336000	451000
BUCKINGHAMSHIRE	3660	332000	463000

county	sales	lower_quartile_price	median_price
BRIGHTON AND HOVE	1932	312000	426000
OXFORDSHIRE	4756	309000	400246
WEST BERKSHIRE	1175	305550	385123
CENTRAL BEDFORDSHIRE	2338	290500	365500
WEST SUSSEX	6756	290500	382500
BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	1388	290000	376000
THURROCK	1079	288000	362000
ESSEX	11297	281200	365500
BEDFORD	1134	281000	345640
CITY OF BRISTOL	3390	280000	356000
SOUTH GLOUCESTERSHIRE	2319	279000	341000
HAMPSHIRE	11055	276000	360750
READING	1047	265500	348000
KENT	11607	265267	348500
EAST SUSSEX	4483	258500	340500

Showing 20 of 89 rows.

Interpretation: The lower-quartile (starter home) price ranges from £387,750 in Greater London to £96,000 in County Durham, a fourfold gap. Across much of the South East, a starter home costs over £300,000.

4. End Consumer 2: Local Authority Housing Planner

A housing planner at a local authority uses sales evidence to set affordable-housing targets and judge whether new supply meets local need. They need district and county comparisons, the scale of new-build activity and its price premium, investor and company buying, price movement between years, and the limits of the data itself.

Easy

Q16

Question: What were the 20 most expensive new-build homes sold in Birmingham across 2025-2026?

Concept: Basic SELECT - WHERE, ORDER BY, LIMIT

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	street	postcode
2025-03-12	925000	D	HAGLEY ROAD	B17 8BL
2025-06-26	650000	D	BATTALION DRIVE	B75 7DN
2025-01-07	625000	D	MULBERRY CLOSE	B72 1RS
2025-06-27	530000	D	GREETMILL HILL ROAD	B28 8FF
2025-10-30	525000	D	HOPKIRK AVENUE	B45 9GE
2025-02-28	520000	D	ACE STREET	B31 5GU
2025-04-11	508500	F	BIRMINGHAM ROAD	B72 1DY
2025-09-16	500400	F	PITT STREET	B4 7FH
2025-05-07	498750	D	GREETMILL HILL ROAD	B28 8FF
2025-06-02	490000	F	SHADWELL STREET	B4 6LQ
2025-06-13	489250	D	STRETTON STREET	B28 8FG
2025-10-31	484750	F	BIRMINGHAM ROAD	B72 1DY
2025-11-14	480000	D	SHELDON DRIVE	B31 5EJ
2025-03-27	480000	D	GREENWAY	B31 5GR
2025-03-31	475000	F	SHADWELL STREET	B4 6LQ
2025-03-28	475000	D	ACE STREET	B31 5GU
2025-06-19	474750	F	BIRMINGHAM ROAD	B72 1DY
2025-02-14	470000	F	BRISTOL ROAD SOUTH	B31 2FT
2025-04-25	470000	F	SHADWELL STREET	B4 6LQ
2025-03-28	470000	F	SHADWELL STREET	B4 6LQ

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The most expensive new-build in Birmingham across 2025–2026 was a £925,000 detached house on Hagley Road (B17). Other detached homes on newer estates in B28, B31, B45, B72 and B75 sold for £475,000–£650,000, and new-build flats in B4, B31 and B72 for £470,000–£508,500. New supply at the top end is therefore split between suburban family houses and premium flats. All 20 sales are from 2025 because of the new-build registration lag.

Q17

Question: Which local authority districts in Kent recorded sales? List each once, alphabetically.

Concept: Basic SELECT - DISTINCT, ORDER BY

district
ASHFORD
CANTERBURY
DARTFORD
DOVER
FOLKESTONE AND HYTHE
GRAVESHAM
MAIDSTONE
SEVENOAKS
SWALE
THANET
TONBRIDGE AND MALLING
TUNBRIDGE WELLS

12 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Kent has 12 local authority districts with recorded sales, from Ashford to Tunbridge Wells. This is the list a county-level planner would use to break Kent's housing market down by authority.

Q18

Question: Which additional-price-paid (category B) sales, such as company or buy-to-let purchases, exceeded £1 million in 2026? Show the 25 largest.

Concept: Basic WHERE - comparison, AND

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	street	town_city	district
2026-01-09	217000000	O	GREAT RUSSELL STREET	LONDON	CAMDEN
2026-03-12	148000000	O	NULL	MANCHESTER	MANCHESTER
2026-02-19	141750000	O	BAKER STREET	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-04-01	93000000	O	ST JAMES'S SQUARE	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-05-15	70500000	O	ELEPHANT & CASTLE	LONDON	SOUTHWARK
2026-07-21	65300000	O	LOAMPIT VALE	LONDON	LEWISHAM
2026-03-27	65000000	O	HANOVER SQUARE	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-05-14	62000000	O	NEW BOND STREET	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-03-31	50475000	O	SMITH SQUARE	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-05-19	50000000	O	BANGRAVE ROAD SOUTH	CORBY	NORTH NORTHAMPTONSHIRE
2026-05-19	50000000	O	BANGRAVE ROAD SOUTH	CORBY	NORTH NORTHAMPTONSHIRE
2026-07-27	49750000	O	THORNHILL ROAD	SWINDON	SWINDON
2026-03-27	45542590	O	REED AVENUE	LONDON	TOWER HAMLETS
2026-03-19	43878177	O	HANNINGTONS LANE	BRIGHTON	BRIGHTON AND HOVE
2026-07-10	42000000	O	CAVENDISH SQUARE	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-07-21	42000000	O	CREATIVE ROAD	LONDON	LEWISHAM
2026-05-01	41185000	O	PARK SPRING ROAD	BARNSLEY	BARNSLEY
2026-01-12	40770000	O	BEAR GARDENS	LONDON	SOUTHWARK
2026-03-13	36875700	O	NURSLING INDUSTRIAL ESTATE	SOUTHAMPTON	TEST VALLEY
2026-01-19	36742625	O	CLAREMONT GROVE	LONDON	HOUNSLOW
2026-01-19	36742625	O	CROFT WAY	RICHMOND	RICHMOND UPON THAMES
2026-01-19	36742625	O	BOWES ROAD	LONDON	ENFIELD
2026-01-19	36742625	O	RATHBONE MARKET	LONDON	NEWHAM
2026-01-19	36742625	O	HANWORTH ROAD	HOUNSLOW	HOUNSLOW
2026-01-19	36742625	O	TANDEM WAY	LONDON	MERTON

25 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: All 25 of the largest category B sales over £1 million in 2026 are property type 'Other', meaning commercial or mixed-use buildings and bulk portfolio purchases rather than individual homes. The largest was £217 million on Great Russell Street in Camden. The same £36,742,625 appears six times on 19 January 2026 across six London boroughs, which shows one portfolio deal recorded against each property. Category B prices therefore should not be mixed with home prices.

Q19

Question: Which 2026 market sales have no postcode recorded, which weakens location-based planning? Show the first 25.

Concept: Basic WHERE - IS NULL

transaction_id	date_of_transfer	price	street	town_city	district
{49E87C31-BC6A-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-07	585000	POUNDS HILL	CREDITON	MID DEVON
{49E87C32-9E63-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-07	575000	UPPER SILK MILL	SHEPTON MALLET	SOMERSET
{49E87C31-C557-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-09	100000	FRONT STREET	DURHAM	COUNTY DURHAM
{49E87C32-34FC-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-12	576000	PURVES ROAD	LONDON	BRENT
{4C1B673E-F70D-D8EA-E063-4704A8C0BF7D}	2026-01-12	390000	POINT ROAD	HAVERFORDWEST	PEMBROKESHIRE
{49E87C32-19C6-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-16	70000	NELSON INN YARD	SPILSBY	EAST LINDSEY
{49E87C32-28AF-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-16	142100	ST IVES COURT	BIRKENHEAD	WIRRAL
{50D10B84-84C1-B8D0-E063-4704A8C08D98}	2026-01-16	67000	RHOSGOCH	BETWS-Y-COED	CONWY
{5834E4E8-8A62-29C7-E063-4804A8C015BC}	2026-01-16	410000	NULL	CAERNARFON	GWYNEDD

transaction_id	date_of_transfer	price	street	town_city	district
{49E87C31-9CDA-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-22	220000	FARNSWORTH COURT	PETERBOROUGH	CITY OF PETERBOROUGH
{49E87C32-0792-591C-E063-4704A8C00C31}	2026-01-23	140000	SOUTH EASTERN ROAD	RAMSGATE	THANET
{5340B1C5-F3C8-8052-E063-4804A8C06EE4}	2026-01-26	160000	SOUTHMEAD	YEOVIL	SOMERSET
{4C1B673F-610D-D8EA-E063-4704A8C0BF7D}	2026-01-29	92250	SCARISBRICK NEW ROAD	SOUTHPORT	SEFTON
{4C1B673E-F50C-D8EA-E063-4704A8C0BF7D}	2026-01-30	750000	NULL	PEMBROKE	PEMBROKESHIRE
{4C1B673F-044B-D8EA-E063-4704A8C0BF7D}	2026-01-30	170000	THE ESPLANADE	WEYMOUTH	DORSET
{4C1B673F-7D70-D8EA-E063-4704A8C0BF7D}	2026-01-30	480000	YORK ROAD	KNARESBOROUGH	NORTH YORKSHIRE
{4E75C29D-B122-8922-E063-4804A8C094D0}	2026-01-30	385000	WOODFIELD LANE	ASHTEAD	MOLE VALLEY
{4C1B673F-6C94-D8EA-E063-4704A8C0BF7D}	2026-02-06	190500	BROOK STREET	NORWICH	BROADLAND
{4C1B673F-A06F-D8EA-E063-4704A8C0BF7D}	2026-02-09	2275000	LEIGH HILL ROAD	COBHAM	ELMBRIDGE
{5834E4E9-4269-29C7-E063-4804A8C015BC}	2026-02-11	155000	HIGH STREET	YEOVIL	SOMERSET
{4E75C29D-5C2E-8922-E063-4804A8C094D0}	2026-02-13	135000	MANNING ROAD	BOURNE	SOUTH KESTEVEN
{4E75C29D-D3D3-8922-E063-4804A8C094D0}	2026-02-16	380000	VICTORIA GARDENS	COLWYN BAY	CONWY

transaction_id	date_of_transfer	price	street	town_city	district
{4E75C29C-E1C3-8922-E063-4804A8C094D0}	2026-02-17	182000	COUNTY ROAD	MARCH	FENLAND
{50D10B84-3B87-B8D0-E063-4704A8C08D98}	2026-02-26	900000	SAINT DUNSTANS AVENUE	LONDON	EALING
{4E75C29C-F122-8922-E063-4804A8C094D0}	2026-02-27	133000	CROSSWALLA FIELDS	HELSTON	CORNWALL

25 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Twenty-five 2026 market sales have no postcode, spread across England and Wales from Pembrokeshire to Elmbridge and priced from £67,000 to £2,275,000. Two also have no street. There is no regional pattern, so this is a minor data-quality gap rather than a bias, but these sales cannot be mapped to a postcode area.

Q20

Question: Which semi-detached houses sold at market value in Leeds, Bradford or Sheffield between January and March 2026? Show the first 30, grouped by district.

Concept: Basic WHERE - IN, BETWEEN

date_of_transfer	price	district	street	postcode
2026-01-01	438000	BRADFORD	FALCON GARDENS	BD16 4FJ
2026-01-05	195000	BRADFORD	DEAN HOUSE GATE	BD15 8HF
2026-01-05	415000	BRADFORD	LEATHLEY AVENUE	LS29 6DN
2026-01-05	192000	BRADFORD	WHARNCLIFFE ROAD	BD18 2AD
2026-01-06	228000	BRADFORD	GRANGE CRESCENT	BD20 5AJ
2026-01-07	171000	BRADFORD	APPLEHAIGH CLOSE	BD10 9DW
2026-01-07	153000	BRADFORD	CLECKHEATON ROAD	BD12 0HL
2026-01-08	330000	BRADFORD	SANDALS ROAD	BD17 5QA
2026-01-08	310000	BRADFORD	HUGHENDON DRIVE	BD13 3AU
2026-01-08	205000	BRADFORD	STAYBRITE AVENUE	BD16 1PR
2026-01-08	192777	BRADFORD	AVERINGCLIFFE ROAD	BD10 9HE

date_of_transfer	price	district	street	postcode
2026-01-08	300000	BRADFORD	FALCON ROAD	BD16 4DP
2026-01-08	157000	BRADFORD	EVERSLEY DRIVE	BD4 0EQ
2026-01-08	245000	BRADFORD	PARK CLOSE	BD16 4EW
2026-01-08	385000	BRADFORD	HAREWOOD HILL	BD22 7NN
2026-01-09	177000	BRADFORD	MOORCROFT AVENUE	BD22 7NE
2026-01-09	162000	BRADFORD	MAYO DRIVE	BD5 8JD
2026-01-09	188000	BRADFORD	SOUTHLANDS ROAD	BD20 5HQ
2026-01-09	165000	BRADFORD	BROUGHTON AVENUE	BD4 6AH
2026-01-09	300000	BRADFORD	FAIRWAY	BD18 4RP
2026-01-09	102000	BRADFORD	SHETCLIFFE LANE	BD4 9RH
2026-01-09	90000	BRADFORD	LYNFIELD DRIVE	BD9 6EY
2026-01-09	207000	BRADFORD	SANDRINGHAM ROAD	BD14 6EA
2026-01-09	235000	BRADFORD	CARRIER LANE	BD2 3FX
2026-01-09	190000	BRADFORD	POPLAR GROVE	BD7 4LL
2026-01-09	160000	BRADFORD	MARTIN COURT	BD6 3XR
2026-01-09	240000	BRADFORD	COLBERT AVENUE	LS29 8LU
2026-01-09	220000	BRADFORD	LANGLEY LANE	BD17 6TB
2026-01-12	280000	BRADFORD	WREXHAM ROAD	LS29 7LS
2026-01-12	165000	BRADFORD	GLENHOLME	BD18 1EW

30 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Because the results are sorted by district, all 30 rows shown are from Bradford, where semi-detached houses sold for £90,000–£438,000 in early January 2026. Inner-city postcodes such as BD4 and BD9 sold for under £170,000, while BD16 (Bingley) and LS29 (Ilkley area) reached £240,000–£438,000, showing a wide price spread within one district. To compare Leeds and Sheffield as well, the limit would need raising or the query grouping by district.

Medium

Q21

Question: Which 20 districts had the highest share of new-build homes among their 2025-2026 market sales (1,000+ sales)?

Concept: GROUP BY / conditional aggregation with HAVING

district	county	sales	new_build_sales	new_build_pct
UTTLESFORD	ESSEX	2370	386	16.3
MELTON	LEICESTERSHIRE	1516	235	15.5
MID SUFFOLK	SUFFOLK	3033	454	15.0
NEWHAM	GREATER LONDON	2917	418	14.3
NORTH WEST LEICESTERSHIRE	LEICESTERSHIRE	2945	413	14.0
MALVERN HILLS	WORCESTERSHIRE	2028	271	13.4
VALE OF WHITE HORSE	OXFORDSHIRE	3500	457	13.1
HARBOROUGH	LEICESTERSHIRE	2731	357	13.1
PRESTON	LANCASHIRE	3222	397	12.3
SOUTH DERBYSHIRE	DERBYSHIRE	3045	373	12.2
TOWER HAMLETS	GREATER LONDON	3971	473	11.9
BEDFORD	BEDFORD	3800	446	11.7
RUGBY	WARWICKSHIRE	2800	328	11.7
DARLINGTON	DARLINGTON	2644	303	11.5
BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	2929	324	11.1
WREKIN	WREKIN	3751	414	11.0
HARTLEPOOL	HARTLEPOOL	2133	230	10.8
RUSHCLIFFE	NOTTINGHAMSHIRE	3286	354	10.8

district	county	sales	new_build_sales	new_build_pct
NUNEATON AND BEDWORTH	WARWICKSHIRE	2950	319	10.8
BASSETLAW	NOTTINGHAMSHIRE	2938	314	10.7

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The highest new-build shares are in growing rural and market-town districts rather than big cities: Uttlesford (16.3%), Melton (15.5%) and Mid Suffolk (15.0%), with Leicestershire appearing three times in the top 8. Newham (14.3%) and Tower Hamlets (11.9%) are the only London boroughs. Because 2026 new-builds are still being registered, these shares mostly reflect 2025 and understate current building.

Q22

Question: In which 15 counties do additional-price-paid sales (category B, e.g. company and buy-to-let purchases) make up the largest share of all sales, 2025-2026?

Concept: GROUP BY / conditional aggregation with HAVING

county	all_sales	category_b_sales	category_b_pct
HARTLEPOOL	3125	992	31.7
MIDDLESBROUGH	3677	1130	30.7
CITY OF KINGSTON UPON HULL	6520	1936	29.7
CITY OF NOTTINGHAM	6180	1730	28.0
SLOUGH	2064	573	27.8
BLACKPOOL	4367	1204	27.6
STOKE-ON-TRENT	6232	1709	27.4
LUTON	3689	972	26.3
LEICESTER	4957	1293	26.1
COUNTY DURHAM	16096	4148	25.8
NORTH EAST LINCOLNSHIRE	4899	1254	25.6
DARLINGTON	3489	845	24.2
SOUTHAMPTON	5594	1332	23.8

county	all_sales	category_b_sales	category_b_pct
MERSEYSIDE	34748	7797	22.4
RHONDDA CYNON TAFF	6035	1327	22.0

15 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Category B sales, which include company and buy-to-let purchases, make up the largest share of all sales in lower-priced northern and Midlands towns: Hartlepool (31.7%), Middlesbrough (30.7%) and Hull (29.7%). Slough, Luton and Leicester also appear. Where nearly a third of purchases are non-standard, investors are likely competing with owner-occupiers for cheaper homes, which a planner should consider alongside affordability.

Q23

Question: For each property type and tenure, how many homes sold at market value in 2026, and at what average price?

Concept: Join (two lookup tables) with GROUP BY

type_name	tenure_name	sales	avg_price
Detached	Freehold	93811	507766
Detached	Leasehold	3005	379424
Flat/Maisonette	Leasehold	61345	291310
Flat/Maisonette	Freehold	1365	300994
Semi-detached	Freehold	112057	332986
Semi-detached	Leasehold	7609	250601
Terraced	Freehold	104062	311041
Terraced	Leasehold	9216	206133

8 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: For houses, leasehold sells far below freehold: leasehold terraced houses averaged £206,133 against £311,041 freehold (34% less), and leasehold semis £250,601 against £332,986. Flats are almost entirely leasehold. The gap suggests leasehold houses are concentrated in cheaper areas and are discounted for lease-related risks.

Q24

Question: In which districts did detached houses average more than £1 million across 2025-2026 (50+ detached sales)?

Concept: GROUP BY / aggregation with HAVING

district	county	detached_sales	avg_detached_price
CAMDEN	GREATER LONDON	53	6969882
MERTON	GREATER LONDON	122	3201838
WANDSWORTH	GREATER LONDON	75	3045655
RICHMOND UPON THAMES	GREATER LONDON	259	1956762
SOUTHWARK	GREATER LONDON	52	1890765
BARNET	GREATER LONDON	483	1695214
EALING	GREATER LONDON	136	1692931
ELMBRIDGE	SURREY	917	1557543
BRENT	GREATER LONDON	105	1396913
HOUNSLOW	GREATER LONDON	88	1339447
HERTSMERE	HERTFORDSHIRE	371	1186555
KINGSTON UPON THAMES	GREATER LONDON	275	1184676
ST ALBANS	HERTFORDSHIRE	715	1181307
LEWISHAM	GREATER LONDON	69	1176267
ENFIELD	GREATER LONDON	227	1164158
THREE RIVERS	HERTFORDSHIRE	420	1163728
OXFORD	OXFORDSHIRE	213	1153659
HARROW	GREATER LONDON	265	1086159
REDBRIDGE	GREATER LONDON	163	1085017
WINDSOR AND MAIDENHEAD	WINDSOR AND MAIDENHEAD	869	1063114
SEVENOAKS	KENT	784	1038851

district	county	detached_sales	avg_detached_price
GREENWICH	GREATER LONDON	114	1025069
BROMLEY	GREATER LONDON	1099	1012707
WAVERLEY	SURREY	1178	1004105

24 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Twenty-four districts had detached houses averaging over £1 million, and 16 of them are London boroughs. Camden leads at £6,969,882 from just 53 sales, followed by Merton (£3.2 million) and Wandsworth (£3.0 million). Outside London, Elmbridge (917 sales at £1,557,543) and Waverley (1,178 sales at £1,004,105) show that £1 million-plus detached homes are routine across parts of Surrey and Hertfordshire.

Q25

Question: For each county, how many districts are there, how many homes sold at market value in 2026, and what were the lowest, highest and average prices?

Concept: GROUP BY / aggregation (COUNT DISTINCT, MIN, MAX, AVG)

county	districts	sales	min_price	max_price	avg_price
GREATER LONDON	33	39781	76500	31900000	657690
GREATER MANCHESTER	10	17317	1200	5450000	284717
WEST YORKSHIRE	5	15502	10000	4000000	250394
WEST MIDLANDS	7	13651	10000	3435000	275232
KENT	12	11607	45000	5198800	395921
ESSEX	12	11297	48000	6402475	411342
HAMPSHIRE	11	11055	56000	14000000	417077
LANCASHIRE	12	9375	20000	2675000	234006
SURREY	11	8835	70000	39500000	600856
MERSEYSIDE	5	8809	14500	2250000	241483
SOUTH YORKSHIRE	4	8475	27000	2825000	226150
HERTFORDSHIRE	10	7784	52000	5200000	531566
NORFOLK	7	7292	27500	2800000	299426
TYNE AND WEAR	5	6911	17000	3075000	212665
WEST SUSSEX	7	6756	50000	5000000	432130
DERBYSHIRE	8	6339	50000	18000000	268533
DEVON	8	6302	800	3499500	344531

county	districts	sales	min_price	max_price	avg_price
STAFFORDSHIRE	8	6298	45000	2415000	283106
NOTTINGHAMSHIRE	7	6016	44000	1700000	269636
LINCOLNSHIRE	7	5989	30000	3200000	255084

Showing 20 of 113 rows.

Interpretation: Greater London is the largest market by far, with 33 districts, 39,781 home sales in 2026 and an average of £657,690. Most other entries are single-district unitary authorities. Average prices range from £150,968 in Hull to £657,690 in London. Maximums such as £39.5 million in Surrey and minimums such as £800 in Devon show that extreme values distort county averages, so medians (Q11, Q15) are a safer planning measure.

Difficult

Q26

Question: Create a reusable like-for-like (Jan-Sep) summary of each district by year. Using it, which 15 districts saw the largest rise in average price from 2025 to 2026, and which 15 the largest fall (300+ sales in each year)?

Concept: VIEW (creates v_district_year) + CTE + window functions (RANK both ways)

grp	district	county	avg_2025	avg_2026	change_pct
Largest rise	HYNDBURN	LANCASHIRE	153243	163962	7.0
Largest rise	WEST LANCASHIRE	LANCASHIRE	281823	299607	6.3
Largest rise	ISLE OF ANGLESEY	ISLE OF ANGLESEY	258472	272421	5.4
Largest rise	BURNLEY	LANCASHIRE	153687	160244	4.3
Largest rise	ADUR	WEST SUSSEX	402305	417873	3.9
Largest rise	PENDLE	LANCASHIRE	176923	183716	3.8
Largest rise	WIRRAL	MERSEYSIDE	257033	266612	3.7
Largest rise	CAERPHILLY	CAERPHILLY	212213	220152	3.7
Largest rise	TRAFFORD	GREATER MANCHESTER	438578	454806	3.7

grp	district	county	avg_2025	avg_2026	change_pct
Largest rise	BRIDGEND	BRIDGEND	236812	245428	3.6
Largest rise	WALTHAM FOREST	GREATER LONDON	567644	585948	3.2
Largest rise	LIVERPOOL	MERSEYSIDE	219698	226761	3.2
Largest rise	BLACKPOOL	BLACKPOOL	149400	154247	3.2
Largest rise	SOUTH KESTEVEN	LINCOLNSHIRE	295783	305391	3.2
Largest rise	MONMOUTHSHIRE	MONMOUTHSHIRE	351443	362453	3.1
Largest fall	COLCHESTER	ESSEX	370813	340261	-8.2
Largest fall	WEST BERKSHIRE	WEST BERKSHIRE	475517	436308	-8.2
Largest fall	SOUTH HAMS	DEVON	448602	411846	-8.2
Largest fall	NEWHAM	GREATER LONDON	471233	431875	-8.4
Largest fall	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON	2019687	1844676	-8.7
Largest fall	RUNNYMEDE	SURREY	574535	522712	-9.0
Largest fall	RUGBY	WARWICKSHIRE	341892	310954	-9.0
Largest fall	CHICHESTER	WEST SUSSEX	548992	495795	-9.7
Largest fall	HERTSMERE	HERTFORDSHIRE	662614	595379	-10.1
Largest fall	TENDRING	ESSEX	320705	287850	-10.2
Largest fall	PORTSMOUTH	PORTSMOUTH	308125	276714	-10.2
Largest fall	HAMMERSMITH AND FULHAM	GREATER LONDON	985430	883725	-10.3
Largest fall	BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	503587	451710	-10.3
Largest fall	TOWER HAMLETS	GREATER LONDON	615542	515548	-16.2

grp	district	county	avg_2025	avg_2026	change_pct
Largest fall	CAMDEN	GREATER LONDON	1236745	1026610	-17.0
Largest fall	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON	1706755	1283078	-24.8

31 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: On a like-for-like January–September basis, the biggest price rises were modest: Hyndburn led at 7.0%, and most of the top 15 are cheaper areas in Lancashire, Merseyside and Wales. The falls were much larger and concentrated in central London: the City of Westminster fell 24.8%, Camden 17.0% and Tower Hamlets 16.2%. Some of the London falls will reflect fewer high-value sales rather than lower values, but the overall pattern is weakness at the top of the market and growth at the bottom. Sixteen districts appear in the falls list because Colchester, West Berkshire and South Hams tie at −8.2%.

Q27

Question: Within each county, how wide is the gap between its most and least expensive district in 2026 (districts with 200+ sales)? Show the 15 counties with the widest gaps.

Concept: CTE (two steps) + aggregation over district averages

county	districts	cheapest_district_avg	dearest_district_avg	gap	ratio
GREATER LONDON	32	374270	1844676	1470406	4.93
CAMBRIDGESHIRE	5	246883	542634	295751	2.20
GLOUCESTERSHIRE	6	267499	564897	297398	2.11
GREATER MANCHESTER	10	220153	454806	234653	2.07
ESSEX	12	287850	594057	306207	2.06
HERTFORDSHIRE	10	349259	707599	358340	2.03
HAMPSHIRE	11	271620	538782	267162	1.98
LANCASHIRE	12	160244	310777	150533	1.94
KENT	12	315480	588631	273151	1.87
WARWICKSHIRE	5	242861	435026	192165	1.79
NOTTINGHAMSHIRE	7	208865	369782	160917	1.77
DERBYSHIRE	8	202307	356875	154568	1.76
SURREY	11	474977	815272	340295	1.72
WEST MIDLANDS	7	228830	390992	162162	1.71
STAFFORDSHIRE	8	228247	370834	142587	1.62

15 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Greater London has by far the widest internal gap: its dearest borough (Kensington and Chelsea, £1,844,676) averages 4.9 times its cheapest (£374,270). In the other 14 counties shown, the ratio is between 1.6 and 2.2. Cambridgeshire, Gloucestershire and Greater Manchester, where Trafford (£454,806) averages over twice the cheapest district, show that large price gaps also exist within counties outside the South East.

Q28

Question: Which 15 districts charge the largest new-build premium over existing homes of the same type across 2025-2026, so the premium is not distorted by property mix (districts with 100+ new-build sales)?

Concept: CTE + join + window function (RANK)

premium_rank	district	county	new_build_sales	new_build_premium_pct
1	HAMMERSMITH AND FULHAM	GREATER LONDON	179	119.0
2	WANDSWORTH	GREATER LONDON	304	102.6
3	LAMBETH	GREATER LONDON	164	91.2
4	TOWER HAMLETS	GREATER LONDON	473	80.6
5	SALFORD	GREATER MANCHESTER	558	67.1
6	BIRMINGHAM	WEST MIDLANDS	524	63.8
7	WINDSOR AND MAIDENHEAD	WINDSOR AND MAIDENHEAD	149	58.5
8	NEWHAM	GREATER LONDON	418	48.9
9	MANCHESTER	GREATER MANCHESTER	369	48.5
10	STOKE-ON-TRENT	STOKE-ON-TRENT	112	46.1
11	BARNET	GREATER LONDON	312	45.4
12	STOCKPORT	GREATER MANCHESTER	101	38.9

premium_rank	district	county	new_build_sales	new_build_premium_pct
13	LIVERPOOL	MERSEYSIDE	158	36.8
14	HOUNSLOW	GREATER LONDON	158	35.6
15	BRACKNELL FOREST	BRACKNELL FOREST	171	32.8

15 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Comparing like-for-like property types, new-builds cost the most extra in inner London: 119% more in Hammersmith and Fulham, 102.6% in Wandsworth and 91.2% in Lambeth. Outside London, Salford (67.1%), Birmingham (63.8%) and Manchester (48.5%) have the largest premiums, all areas with major city-centre flat developments. A large premium means new supply is aimed at the top of the market rather than at local affordability.

Q29

Question: How has the monthly number of new-build sales moved across all 21 months, and what is its 3-month moving average (shown from the third month onward)?

Concept: CTE + window function (moving average with ROWS frame)

sale_month	new_build_sales	moving_avg_3m
2025-01	3455	NULL
2025-02	4295	NULL
2025-03	9313	5688
2025-04	2949	5519
2025-05	4604	5622
2025-06	8304	5286
2025-07	3712	5540
2025-08	4184	5400
2025-09	4745	4214
2025-10	4391	4440
2025-11	3449	4195
2025-12	1656	3165

sale_month	new_build_sales	moving_avg_3m
2026-01	224	1776
2026-02	111	664
2026-03	178	171
2026-04	96	128
2026-05	57	110
2026-06	50	68
2026-07	35	47
2026-08	10	32
2026-09	5	17

21 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Through 2025, monthly new-build sales ran between about 3,000 and 9,300, with peaks in March (9,313) and June (8,304) that likely reflect quarter-end completions. From December 2025 the figures collapse to just 5 in September 2026. This is the registration lag for new-builds, not a real collapse in building. The moving average shows the lag clearly, and it means 2026 new-build figures cannot yet be used for planning.

Q30

Question: Using the district summary, which districts saw sales volumes fall while prices still rose (Jan-Sep 2025 vs Jan-Sep 2026), a sign of supply pressure?

Concept: Uses v_district_year (self-join) + filtering on changes

district	county	sales_2025	sales_2026	volume_change_pct	price_change_pct
HYNDBURN	LANCASHIRE	863	600	-30.5	7.0
WEST LANCASHIRE	LANCASHIRE	1305	796	-39.0	6.3
ISLE OF ANGLESEY	ISLE OF ANGLESEY	626	405	-35.3	5.4
BURNLEY	LANCASHIRE	1100	742	-32.5	4.3
ADUR	WEST SUSSEX	736	465	-36.8	3.9
PENDLE	LANCASHIRE	1073	708	-34.0	3.8
TRAFFORD	GREATER MANCHESTER	2401	1671	-30.4	3.7
WIRRAL	MERSEYSIDE	3540	2475	-30.1	3.7
CAERPHILLY	CAERPHILLY	1666	1156	-30.6	3.7

district	county	sales_2025	sales_2026	volume_change_pct	price_change_pct
BRIDGEND	BRIDGEND	1455	1109	-23.8	3.6
SOUTH KESTEVEN	LINCOLNSHIRE	1870	1196	-36.0	3.2
WALTHAM FOREST	GREATER LONDON	2233	1348	-39.6	3.2
BLACKPOOL	BLACKPOOL	1505	1048	-30.4	3.2
LIVERPOOL	MERSEYSIDE	3666	2438	-33.5	3.2
MONMOUTHSHIRE	MONMOUTHSHIRE	999	723	-27.6	3.1
EREWASH	DERBYSHIRE	1256	895	-28.7	2.9
BLAENAU GWENT	BLAENAU GWENT	607	368	-39.4	2.8
CEREDIGION	CEREDIGION	634	476	-24.9	2.6
WALSALL	WEST MIDLANDS	2204	1378	-37.5	2.5
STROUD	GLOUCESTERSHIRE	1514	912	-39.8	2.4

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: All 20 districts saw sales volumes fall while average prices rose, led by Hyndburn (volume −30.5%, price +7.0%) and West Lancashire (−39.0%, +6.3%). Because 2026 sales are still being registered, every district's 2026 volume is understated, so the volume falls should be read with caution. The price rises are the stronger signal, and they are concentrated in Lancashire, Merseyside and South Wales, where demand appears to be outpacing supply.

5. End Consumer 3: Property Market Journalist

A journalist covering the property market needs stories that are accurate as well as striking: record sales, the shape of the market by price band, seasonal and monthly patterns, where activity is rising or falling, and which eye-catching figures are genuine and which are data quirks that should not be reported as home sales.

Easy

Q31

Question: What were the 10 most expensive property sales of any kind recorded in 2026?

Concept: Basic SELECT - ORDER BY, LIMIT

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	ppd_category	paon	street	town_city	district
2026-01-09	217000000	O	B	112	GREAT RUSSELL STREET	LONDON	CAMDEN
2026-03-12	148000000	O	B	WESTERN MAINTENANCE AREA	NULL	MANCHESTER	MANCHESTER

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	ppd_category	paon	street	town_city	district
2026-02-19	141750000	O	B	215	BAKER STREET	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-04-01	93000000	O	B	33	ST JAMES'S SQUARE	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-05-15	70500000	O	B	LONDON COLLEGE OF COMMUNICATION	ELEPHANT & CASTLE	LONDON	SOUTHWARK
2026-07-21	65300000	O	B	LINDSAY COURT	LOAMPIT VALE	LONDON	LEWISHAM
2026-03-27	65000000	O	B	13	HANOVER SQUARE	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-05-14	62000000	O	B	170	NEW BOND STREET	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-03-31	50475000	O	B	NOBEL HOUSE, 17	SMITH SQUARE	LONDON	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-05-19	50000000	O	B	MAX PARK UNIT 4	BANGRAVE ROAD SOUTH	CORBY	NORTH NORTHAMPTONSHIRE

10 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The 10 biggest sales of 2026 were all category B 'Other' property: commercial buildings and institutional deals, not homes. They are led by £217 million at 112 Great Russell Street in Camden, £148 million for a maintenance site in Manchester and £141.75 million on Baker Street. Eight of the ten are in London. Headline 'record price' stories need to separate these from residential sales.

Q32

Question: Which homes sold at market value for £5 million or more in 2025?

Concept: Basic WHERE - comparison, BETWEEN

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	street	district	county
2025-09-03	53000000	D	AVENUE ROAD	CAMDEN	GREATER LONDON
2025-06-27	41000000	D	HOLLAND PARK	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON
2025-09-19	36000000	S	ORCHARD CLOSE	NORWICH	NORFOLK
2025-03-04	36000000	T	MULBERRY SQUARE	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON
2025-01-31	34000000	T	WILTON CRESCENT	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON
2025-12-15	34000000	F	KNIGHTSBRIDGE	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON
2025-01-15	32000000	D	QUEENS GROVE	CAMDEN	GREATER LONDON

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	street	district	county
2025-05-29	29500000	D	DOROTHY AVENUE	DONCASTER	SOUTH YORKSHIRE
2025-01-31	28500000	D	ADDISON ROAD	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON
2025-09-30	27300000	F	WEBSTER CLOSE	BRACKNELL FOREST	BRACKNELL FOREST
2025-08-22	25900000	D	MERTON LANE	CAMDEN	GREATER LONDON
2025-01-08	25880000	D	AVENUE ROAD	CAMDEN	GREATER LONDON
2025-12-03	25400000	F	GLEBE PLACE	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON
2025-05-15	24500000	T	CHEYNE WALK	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON
2025-01-15	24000000	S	LANSDOWNE CRESCENT	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON
2025-11-21	23250000	F	WILLIAM STREET	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON
2025-08-22	22500000	T	HARLESTON ROAD	PORTSMOUTH	PORTSMOUTH
2025-11-19	22000000	T	KENSINGTON PARK GARDENS	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON
2025-04-28	21788318	D	DAWSON PLACE	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON
2025-06-27	21400000	T	SHAKESPEARE ROAD	PORTSMOUTH	PORTSMOUTH

Showing 20 of 464 rows.

Interpretation: In 2025, 464 homes sold at market value for £5 million or more, and 401 of them (86%) were in Greater London. Westminster (145) and Kensington and Chelsea (131) alone account for 60%. The top sale was £53 million on Avenue Road in Camden. Some entries look implausible as single homes, such as a £36 million semi in Norwich, £29.5 million in Doncaster and £22.5 million for a terraced house in Portsmouth, and are more likely bulk purchases recorded against one address, so a journalist should verify them before reporting.

Q33

Question: Which were the 20 most expensive market sales that completed on Christmas Eve or New Year's Eve 2025?

Concept: Basic WHERE - IN, ORDER BY, LIMIT

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	town_city	district
2025-12-24	1489900	F	LONDON	CAMDEN
2025-12-24	640000	T	ENFIELD	ENFIELD
2025-12-24	470000	F	LONDON	TOWER HAMLETS
2025-12-31	430000	T	HORNCHURCH	HAVERING
2025-12-24	422000	F	LONDON	ISLINGTON
2025-12-31	375000	D	CHELMSFORD	CHELMSFORD
2025-12-31	369200	T	HARROGATE	NORTH YORKSHIRE
2025-12-24	315000	D	SWINDON	SWINDON
2025-12-31	310000	D	BOLTON	BOLTON
2025-12-24	307250	S	EASTBOURNE	WEALDEN
2025-12-31	254995	S	GATESHEAD	GATESHEAD
2025-12-31	119999	T	PETERLEE	COUNTY DURHAM
2025-12-31	113999	S	PETERLEE	COUNTY DURHAM
2025-12-24	98999	T	FERRYHILL	COUNTY DURHAM
2025-12-24	96999	T	HARTLEPOOL	HARTLEPOOL
2025-12-31	96999	T	MIDDLESBROUGH	MIDDLESBROUGH
2025-12-31	96999	T	FERRYHILL	COUNTY DURHAM
2025-12-31	96999	T	SEAHAM	COUNTY DURHAM
2025-12-24	95000	S	WREXHAM	WREXHAM
2025-12-24	88999	T	MIDDLESBROUGH	REDCAR AND CLEVELAND

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The most expensive sale completed on Christmas Eve or New Year's Eve 2025 was a £1,489,900 flat in Camden, but most of the 20 were modest. Eight were in County Durham, Hartlepool, Middlesbrough and Redcar for £88,999–£119,999, and the repeated £96,999 price suggests a developer or bulk scheme completing before the year end.

Q34

Question: Which homes on a "High Street" sold at market value for over £1 million in 2026? Show the 25 most expensive.

Concept: Basic WHERE - LIKE

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	paon	street	town_city
2026-01-09	4800000	D	OAKLANDS	HIGH STREET	YORK
2026-03-03	4000000	F	302	HIGH STREET	WETHERBY
2026-01-16	2850000	F	EXECUTION DOCK HOUSE, 80	WAPPING HIGH STREET	LONDON
2026-08-14	2725000	D	WINFRITH HOUSE	HIGH STREET	DORCHESTER
2026-07-14	2635000	D	WOODHAM HOUSE	HIGH STREET	MUCH HADHAM
2026-04-08	2300000	D	41	HIGH STREET	CHIPPING NORTON
2026-07-01	2290000	D	64	HIGH STREET	CAMBRIDGE
2026-01-15	2275000	F	MELBURY COURT	KENSINGTON HIGH STREET	LONDON
2026-02-19	1830000	F	ST. JOHNS WHARF, 104 - 106	WAPPING HIGH STREET	LONDON
2026-03-19	1765000	D	THE GRANGE	HIGH STREET	BEDFORD
2026-03-31	1725000	F	CINNABAR WHARF WEST, 22	WAPPING HIGH STREET	LONDON
2026-06-26	1685000	T	50	HIGH STREET	BRUTON
2026-02-11	1625000	D	29	HIGH STREET	SOUTHAMPTON
2026-03-25	1625000	D	MIDDLE FARM	HIGH STREET	CHIPPING NORTON
2026-01-05	1610000	D	BRIDGE END HOUSE, 2	HIGH STREET	WALLINGFORD
2026-05-29	1575000	F	92	ISLINGTON HIGH STREET	LONDON
2026-04-16	1550000	T	THE LANTERNS	HIGH STREET	CHIPPING CAMPDEN
2026-05-15	1500000	F	ST HILDAS WHARF, 170	WAPPING HIGH STREET	LONDON
2026-06-11	1450000	D	35	HIGH STREET	BALDOCK
2026-03-30	1375000	D	GALLEON HOUSE	HIGH STREET	CHICHESTER

date_of_transfer	price	property_type	paon	street	town_city
2026-02-19	1300000	T	36	HIGH STREET	NEWCASTLE UPON TYNE
2026-08-19	1300000	D	THE OLD VICARAGE	HIGH STREET	SAFFRON WALDEN
2026-05-29	1300000	D	RED TILES	HIGH STREET	MAIDENHEAD
2026-09-01	1280000	D	33A	HIGH STREET	INGATESTONE
2026-08-27	1250000	D	18	HIGH STREET	ABINGDON

25 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The most expensive 'High Street' home in 2026 was Oaklands in York at £4.8 million, followed by a £4 million flat in Wetherby that Q45 flags as an outlier. Wapping High Street in London appears four times with riverside warehouse flats at £1.5–2.85 million. Most of the rest are period houses in wealthy market towns such as Chipping Norton, Chipping Campden and Saffron Walden.

Q35

Question: Which new-build flats in London (town "LONDON") sold at market value for under £400,000 in 2026?

Concept: Basic WHERE - AND conditions

date_of_transfer	price	saon	street	postcode	district
2026-06-03	250000	APARTMENT 1	MANOR WAY	SE3 9AN	GREENWICH
2026-05-29	255000	APARTMENT 4	MANOR WAY	SE3 9AN	GREENWICH
2026-01-12	275000	FLAT 12	HIGH ROAD	N20 0RA	BARNET
2026-07-10	345000	FLAT 165	MAIDA VALE	W9 1QQ	CITY OF WESTMINSTER
2026-02-03	346500	FLAT 403	LANGHAM GROVE	SE28 0FY	GREENWICH
2026-01-30	350000	FLAT 32	ADELAIDE ROAD	E10 5NN	WALTHAM FOREST
2026-01-16	375000	APARTMENT 6	SYLVAN ROAD	E11 1QN	REDBRIDGE
2026-02-19	375000	APARTMENT 4	SYLVAN ROAD	E11 1QN	REDBRIDGE
2026-02-20	385000	FLAT 3	HIGH ROAD	N20 0RA	BARNET
2026-03-31	387500	FLAT 149	MAIDA VALE	W9 1QG	CITY OF WESTMINSTER

date_of_transfer	price	saon	street	postcode	district
2026-01-21	398500	FLAT G06	GOODLUCK HOPE WALK	E14 0XF	TOWER HAMLETS
2026-04-10	398775	FLAT 2103	WEST PARKSIDE	SE10 0UX	GREENWICH

12 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Only 12 new-build flats in London were recorded as selling for under £400,000 in 2026, the cheapest at £250,000 on Manor Way in Greenwich (SE3). Greenwich accounts for four of the 12. The small number reflects both London prices and the new-build registration lag, so this is not a full count of affordable new supply.

Medium

Q36

Question: How many homes sold at market value each month, and at what average price, from January 2025 to September 2026?

Concept: GROUP BY / aggregation on date parts

sale_year	sale_month	sales	avg_price
2025	1	57425	377355
2025	2	65533	368810
2025	3	123761	387595
2025	4	34022	337607
2025	5	53862	352523
2025	6	64392	362041
2025	7	69612	379236
2025	8	72888	383479
2025	9	69250	381700
2025	10	80184	372407
2025	11	68717	377708
2025	12	63008	358879
2026	1	45692	370059

sale_year	sale_month	sales	avg_price
2026	2	48790	355985
2026	3	53435	356043
2026	4	45622	365074
2026	5	45355	353663
2026	6	43823	347453
2026	7	49392	355096
2026	8	41853	361028
2026	9	18508	360353

21 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Sales spiked to 123,761 in March 2025, almost double the surrounding months, then collapsed to 34,022 in April, the month stamp duty thresholds were lowered. Buyers rushed to complete before the change. Monthly 2026 sales of about 42,000–53,000 are below 2025 levels partly because recent sales are still being registered, and September 2026 (18,508) is clearly incomplete. Average prices stayed in a narrow £337,000–£388,000 band throughout.

Q37

Question: Which 10 counties had the highest average market price in 2026 (counties with at least 2,000 sales)?

Concept: GROUP BY / aggregation with HAVING

county	sales	avg_price
GREATER LONDON	39781	657690
SURREY	8835	600856
BUCKINGHAMSHIRE	3660	549667
HERTFORDSHIRE	7784	531566
OXFORDSHIRE	4756	478511
WEST SUSSEX	6756	432130
HAMPSHIRE	11055	417077

county	sales	avg_price
ESSEX	11297	411342
CITY OF BRISTOL	3390	399474
KENT	11607	395921

10 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The ten most expensive counties in 2026 are all in the South of England, led by Greater London (£657,690), Surrey (£600,856) and Buckinghamshire (£549,667). The City of Bristol (£399,474) is the only one outside London and the Home Counties.

Q38

Question: How are 2026 market sales spread across price bands, and what share of the market does each band hold?

Concept: GROUP BY on a CASE expression + share of total

price_band	sales	share_pct
1. Under 125k	27153	6.9
2. 125k-250k	125284	31.9
3. 250k-500k	171024	43.6
4. 500k-1m	59679	15.2
5. 1m and over	9330	2.4

5 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: In 2026, 43.6% of homes sold for £250,000–£500,000 and a further 31.9% for £125,000–£250,000, so three in four sales fall between £125,000 and £500,000. Million-pound homes are rare at 2.4% (9,330 sales), while 6.9% sold for under £125,000. The bands add up to all 392,470 home sales in 2026.

Q39

Question: On which days of the week do house sales complete, and is Friday really the busiest completion day (2025-2026)?

Concept: GROUP BY on a date function (DAYNAME / DAYOFWEEK)

weekday	sales	share_pct
Sunday	622	0.1
Monday	180107	14.8
Tuesday	128964	10.6
Wednesday	149554	12.3
Thursday	192304	15.8
Friday	562940	46.3
Saturday	633	0.1

7 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Yes. Friday is by far the busiest completion day, with 46.3% of all sales, three times Thursday (15.8%), the next busiest. Tuesday is the quietest weekday (10.6%), and weekend completions are almost non-existent at 0.1% each. Buyers and conveyancers favour Fridays so that moves can happen over the weekend.

Q40

Question: For each property type, how many £1 million-plus market sales were there in 2025-2026, and what share of all million-pound sales does each type make up?

Concept: Join (lookup table) + GROUP BY + share of total

type_name	million_plus_sales	avg_price	share_pct
Detached	18014	1561315	52.0
Terraced	7442	1757295	21.5
Semi-detached	4774	1642380	13.8
Flat/Maisonette	4424	1859855	12.8

4 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: There were 34,654 market home sales of £1 million or more across 2025–2026. Detached houses make up 52% of them, but million-pound flats have the highest average (£1,859,855), reflecting prime London apartments. Terraced houses (21.5%) outnumber semis, because London's period terraces regularly sell for over £1 million.

Difficult

Q41

Question: Create a reusable monthly market summary. Using it, how did the average price change from one month to the next, in pounds and in percent?

Concept: VIEW (creates v_monthly_market) + window function (LAG)

sale_month	sales	avg_price	change_gbp	change_pct
2025-01	57425	377355	NULL	NULL
2025-02	65533	368810	-8545	-2.26
2025-03	123761	387595	18785	5.09
2025-04	34022	337607	-49988	-12.90
2025-05	53862	352523	14916	4.42
2025-06	64392	362041	9518	2.70
2025-07	69612	379236	17195	4.75
2025-08	72888	383479	4243	1.12
2025-09	69250	381700	-1779	-0.46
2025-10	80184	372407	-9293	-2.43
2025-11	68717	377708	5301	1.42
2025-12	63008	358879	-18830	-4.99
2026-01	45692	370059	11180	3.12
2026-02	48790	355985	-14074	-3.80
2026-03	53435	356043	58	0.02
2026-04	45622	365074	9031	2.54
2026-05	45355	353663	-11411	-3.13
2026-06	43823	347453	-6210	-1.76
2026-07	49392	355096	7643	2.20
2026-08	41853	361028	5932	1.67
2026-09	18508	360353	-674	-0.19

21 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: The largest monthly move was April 2025, when the average price fell 12.9% (£49,988) straight after a 5.1% rise in March, the stamp duty rush. December 2025 fell 5.0%. Through 2026 the average moved by no more than about 4% a month and ended September at £360,353, below January 2025's £377,355. Month-to-month changes mostly reflect the mix of homes sold rather than a real change in values.

Q42

Question: Using the monthly summary, how did the total value of homes sold build up through each year, as a running total that restarts each January?

Concept: Uses v_monthly_market + window function (running SUM partitioned by year)

sale_month	sales	value_gbp_m	year_to_date_gbp_bn
2025-01	57425	21669.6	21.67
2025-02	65533	24169.2	45.84
2025-03	123761	47969.1	93.81
2025-04	34022	11486.1	105.29
2025-05	53862	18987.6	124.28
2025-06	64392	23312.6	147.59
2025-07	69612	26399.4	173.99
2025-08	72888	27951.0	201.94
2025-09	69250	26432.7	228.38
2025-10	80184	29861.1	258.24
2025-11	68717	25955.0	284.19
2025-12	63008	22612.2	306.81
2026-01	45692	16908.7	16.91
2026-02	48790	17368.5	34.28
2026-03	53435	19025.2	53.30
2026-04	45622	16655.4	69.96
2026-05	45355	16040.4	86.00
2026-06	43823	15226.4	101.22

sale_month	sales	value_gbp_m	year_to_date_gbp_bn
2026-07	49392	17538.9	118.76
2026-08	41853	15110.1	133.87
2026-09	18508	6669.4	140.54

21 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Homes worth £306.81 billion sold in 2025, with March alone contributing £47.97 billion because of the stamp duty rush. By September 2026 the running total had reached £140.54 billion, compared with £228.38 billion at the same point in 2025. Much of that gap is registration lag rather than a real 38% drop.

Q43

Question: What were the three most expensive home sales in each county in 2026?

Concept: CTE + window function (ROW_NUMBER within a partition)

county	price_rank	price	type_name	street	district	date_of_transfer
BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	1	3500000	Detached	VAN DIEMEN'S LANE	BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	2026-01-16
BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	2	2450000	Semi-detached	HENRIETTA VILLAS	BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	2026-01-08
BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	3	2425000	Detached	CLAVERTON DOWN ROAD	BATH AND NORTH EAST SOMERSET	2026-06-26
BEDFORD	1	1765000	Detached	HIGH STREET	BEDFORD	2026-03-19
BEDFORD	2	1600000	Detached	PARK AVENUE	BEDFORD	2026-08-10
BEDFORD	3	1545000	Detached	KEYSOE ROW WEST	BEDFORD	2026-03-25
BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	1	1400000	Detached	MOORSIDE ROAD	BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	2026-02-25
BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	2	960000	Detached	PLEASINGTON LANE	BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	2026-02-26
BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	3	945000	Detached	RIVINGTON ROAD	BLACKBURN WITH DARWEN	2026-05-22
BLACKPOOL	1	475000	Detached	NORTHGATE	BLACKPOOL	2026-08-21
BLACKPOOL	2	470000	Detached	THE KNOWLE	BLACKPOOL	2026-03-31
BLACKPOOL	3	465000	Detached	WARBRECK HILL ROAD	BLACKPOOL	2026-04-13
BLAENAU GWENT	1	500000	Detached	PORTERS ROAD	BLAENAU GWENT	2026-05-11
BLAENAU GWENT	2	445000	Detached	PANT Y FFOREST	BLAENAU GWENT	2026-06-23

county	price_rank	price	type_name	street	district	date_of_transfer
BLAENAU GWENT	3	440000	Semi-detached	MAES THORNTON	BLAENAU GWENT	2026-01-23
BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	1	7100000	Detached	PANORAMA ROAD	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	2026-07-03
BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	2	5750000	Detached	PANORAMA ROAD	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	2026-03-26
BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	3	4500000	Detached	WESTERN AVENUE	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	2026-03-06
BRACKNELL FOREST	1	3625000	Detached	NORTH STREET	BRACKNELL FOREST	2026-02-16
BRACKNELL FOREST	2	3212509	Detached	WINKFIELD STREET	BRACKNELL FOREST	2026-05-21

Showing 20 of 339 rows.

Interpretation: All 113 counties appear with their top three 2026 sales (339 rows). The most expensive sale per county ranges from £475,000 in Blackpool to £39.5 million in Surrey, and 310 of the 339 are detached houses. Several county record-holders, including £18 million in Derbyshire, £19.5 million for a semi in North Northamptonshire and the £39.5 million Surrey terrace, are flagged as outliers in Q45, so they may not be single homes.

Q44

Question: Using the district summary, where is market activity heating up? Rank districts by the like-for-like rise in sales volume from Jan-Sep 2025 to Jan-Sep 2026 (300+ sales in 2025), alongside their price change.

Concept: Uses v_district_year + window function (DENSE_RANK)

activity_rank	district	county	sales_2025	sales_2026	volume_change_pct	price_change_pct
1	IPSWICH	SUFFOLK	1161	931	-19.8	-1.2
2	DENBIGHSHIRE	DENBIGHSHIRE	950	742	-21.9	1.1
3	ROTHER	EAST SUSSEX	1015	784	-22.8	-4.2
4	BRIDGEND	BRIDGEND	1455	1109	-23.8	3.6
5	NORTH NORFOLK	NORFOLK	1227	930	-24.2	-5.4
6	TORBAY	TORBAY	1581	1198	-24.2	-2.4
7	CEREDIGION	CEREDIGION	634	476	-24.9	2.6
8	LINCOLN	LINCOLNSHIRE	956	713	-25.4	0.1
9	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	4294	3182	-25.9	-0.8
10	CITY OF PLYMOUTH	CITY OF PLYMOUTH	2883	2136	-25.9	-1.7
11	GOSPORT	HAMPSHIRE	890	657	-26.2	-2.5
12	SURREY HEATH	SURREY	984	723	-26.5	1.5

activity_rank	district	county	sales_2025	sales_2026	volume_change_pct	price_change_pct
13	HAVANT	HAMPSHIRE	1321	967	-26.8	-0.9
13	SHROPSHIRE	SHROPSHIRE	3422	2505	-26.8	0.0
14	CITY OF BRISTOL	CITY OF BRISTOL	4635	3390	-26.9	-0.7
15	CITY OF DERBY	CITY OF DERBY	2332	1701	-27.1	-1.2
16	EASTLEIGH	HAMPSHIRE	1644	1195	-27.3	-1.5
17	SOUTHAMPTON	SOUTHAMPTON	2040	1482	-27.4	-2.7
18	MONMOUTHSHIRE	MONMOUTHSHIRE	999	723	-27.6	3.1
19	NORWICH	NORFOLK	1418	1026	-27.6	-6.9

20 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: No district increased its sales volume between January–September 2025 and the same months in 2026. Even the top-ranked, Ipswich, is down 19.8%, which shows the 2026 registration lag. The ranking is still useful in relative terms: Ipswich, Denbighshire and Rother have held activity up best. Their price changes are mixed, from Norwich (−6.9%) to Bridgend (+3.6%). Havant and Shropshire share 13th place because DENSE_RANK gives tied values the same rank.

Q45

Question: Which 2026 sales were extreme outliers, at more than ten times the average price for the same property type in the same district?

Concept: CTE + window function (AVG OVER a partition)

date_of_transfer	price	type_name	street	district	county	local_type_avg	times_local_avg
2026-01-09	19500000	Semi-detached	LITTLEWOOD STREET	NORTH NORTHAMPTONSHIRE	NORTH NORTHAMPTONSHIRE	275527	70.8
2026-05-11	39500000	Terraced	CHERRY TREE LANE	WAVERLEY	SURREY	641283	61.6
2026-02-20	18000000	Detached	MILL ROAD	AMBER VALLEY	DERBYSHIRE	419101	42.9
2026-04-24	12000000	Flat/Maisonette	PARKSIDE	MERTON	GREATER LONDON	454516	26.4
2026-05-29	5118021	Flat/Maisonette	BRIDGE ROAD	CORNWALL	CORNWALL	209765	24.4
2026-03-03	4000000	Flat/Maisonette	HIGH STREET	LEEDS	WEST YORKSHIRE	170081	23.5
2026-04-27	22800000	Flat/Maisonette	PARK CRESCENT	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON	993863	22.9
2026-09-01	14000000	Detached	NULL	TEST VALLEY	HAMPSHIRE	654042	21.4
2026-04-15	17668812	Flat/Maisonette	WILLIAM STREET	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON	993863	17.8
2026-06-11	30000000	Detached	THE BISHOPS AVENUE	BARNET	GREATER LONDON	1850784	16.2
2026-01-30	8333000	Flat/Maisonette	NEW GLOBE WALK	SOUTHWARK	GREATER LONDON	528638	15.8

date_of_transfer	price	type_name	street	district	county	local_type_avg	times_local_avg
2026-01-30	8333000	Flat/Maisonette	NEW GLOBE WALK	SOUTHWARK	GREATER LONDON	528638	15.8
2026-01-27	5100000	Terraced	THE PUREY CUST	YORK	YORK	346578	14.7
2026-05-01	13200000	Flat/Maisonette	MONTROSE PLACE	CITY OF WESTMINSTER	GREATER LONDON	993863	13.3
2026-07-03	7100000	Detached	PANORAMA ROAD	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	555677	12.8
2026-03-27	8500000	Detached	NULL	WEST OXFORDSHIRE	OXFORDSHIRE	713223	11.9
2026-07-01	9000000	Flat/Maisonette	NEW OXFORD STREET	CAMDEN	GREATER LONDON	770016	11.7
2026-07-24	12700000	Flat/Maisonette	VICARAGE GATE	KENSINGTON AND CHELSEA	GREATER LONDON	1128322	11.3
2026-07-31	6270500	Detached	NULL	CHERWELL	OXFORDSHIRE	577493	10.9
2026-08-11	4368859	Detached	QUARR ROAD	ISLE OF WIGHT	ISLE OF WIGHT	404801	10.8
2026-01-09	5400000	Detached	LEYCESTER ROAD	CHESHIRE EAST	CHESHIRE EAST	519316	10.4
2026-03-26	5750000	Detached	PANORAMA ROAD	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	BOURNEMOUTH, CHRISTCHURCH AND POOLE	555677	10.3
2026-01-09	4800000	Detached	HIGH STREET	NORTH YORKSHIRE	NORTH YORKSHIRE	479493	10.0

23 rows returned (shown in full).

Interpretation: Twenty-three 2026 sales were more than ten times the local average for their property type. The most extreme was a £19.5 million semi in North Northamptonshire, 70.8 times the local average, followed by a £39.5 million terrace in Waverley (61.6 times) and an £18 million detached house in Amber Valley (42.9 times). The same £8,333,000 appears twice on New Globe Walk in Southwark. Such sales are likely bulk or mixed-use deals recorded as single homes, so a journalist should check each one before calling it a record.

6. Summary of Findings

End consumer	Key finding
First-time buyer adviser	Starter-home prices range from a lower quartile of £96,000 in County Durham to £387,750 in Greater London (Q15). Flats are the cheapest entry point but are almost always leasehold (Q7). Large cities such as Birmingham and Leeds combine plenty of homes for sale with below-average entry prices (Q13).

End consumer	Key finding
Local authority housing planner	New-build premiums are highest in inner London, Salford and Birmingham, where new supply is aimed at the top of the market (Q28). Company and buy-to-let purchases make up almost a third of sales in Hartlepool, Middlesbrough and Hull (Q22). Prices rose fastest in cheaper Lancashire, Merseyside and Welsh districts, while central London fell (Q26).
Property market journalist	The March 2025 stamp duty rush nearly doubled monthly sales before an April collapse (Q36, Q41). Friday accounts for 46% of completions (Q39). The biggest 'record' prices are often commercial or bulk deals rather than single homes, so they need checking before publication (Q31, Q45).

Throughout the analysis, the main limitation is the registration lag. Recent sales, especially new-builds, take months to appear in the Price Paid Data, so 2026 volumes are understated (Q29, Q44). Price comparisons are therefore more reliable than volume comparisons, and medians and lower quartiles are more reliable than averages, which a small number of extreme sales can distort.